

**SINGLE SOURCE DETERMINATION USING
SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION PROCEDURES (SAP)
FOR AN ACTION NOT EXCEEDING THE SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION THRESHOLD
(AUTHORITY: FAR 13.106-1(b)(1))**

1. Agency and contracting activity.

Department of Commerce
NOAA Acquisition and Grants Office (AGO)
Western Acquisition Division
Alaska Fisheries Science Center (AFSC) and Resource Assessment & Conservation Engineering
Division (RACE)

2. Description of supplies or services required to meet agency needs (including the estimated value).

This service will be contracted to provide expert identification and curation of specimens collected during NOAA bottom-trawl surveys in Alaskan waters. Preserved invertebrate specimens will be provided to the contractor, who will identify them to the lowest possible taxon and curate them within an internationally recognized systematic collection. Once archived in the collection, specimens will be available by loan to researchers around the world. Information associated with the specimens will also be available on the internet.



The base period of performance will be July 1 2026 to June 30 2027
Option 1: July 1 2027 to June 30 2028
Option 2: July 1 2028 to June 30 2029
Option 3: July 1 2029 to June 30 2030
Option 4: July 1 2030 to June 30 2031

3. Identification of the single source or the brand name to be solicited.

Charlotte Seid

Benthic Invertebrate Collection
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San Diego, CA 92121
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4. Supporting rationale. Only one source or brand name is reasonably available as detailed below:

X Other - Only one source is capable – We are in need of highly technical expertise to identify and describe invertebrate species from North Pacific waters collected on our bottom trawl surveys in Alaskan waters. Expert familiarity with the invertebrate species of this region is necessary to perform the services and NOAA does not possess the expertise required to adequately complete this task. Furthermore, NOAA does not have the resources to accession, curate, or make collected specimens available to researchers around the world.

The Scripps Institution of Oceanography (SIO) Benthic Invertebrate Collection (SIO-BIC) houses more than 86,000 curated lots, representing over one million individual specimens from global marine environments, making it one of the largest and most taxonomically comprehensive marine invertebrate collections in the United States. These holdings span over 9,000 species, including 700+ type lots and more than 120 holotypes, providing essential comparative material for accurate species-level identifications. SIO-BIC collections encompass a wide geographic and ecological range, including the eastern North Pacific, deep-sea habitats, chemosynthetic ecosystems (hydrothermal vents, seeps, whale falls), polar regions, and extensive historical expeditions. This breadth is directly relevant to NOAA's Alaska bottom trawl surveys, which routinely encounter deep-sea and poorly described benthic invertebrate taxa that require comparison to expertly curated reference material.

SIO-BIC also maintains ethanol-preserved specimens suitable for DNA and genomic analyses, enabling both traditional morphological taxonomy and modern molecular approaches. The collection includes numerous historical NOAA-related deep-sea samples integrated over several decades, and SIO has a demonstrated institutional capacity to curate, organize, and rescue large scientific collections from other marine research programs as researchers retire. The collection is actively used by visiting scientists and is linked to global biodiversity data platforms via digitization projects, ensuring broad accessibility for future comparative work.

Scripps' taxonomic and curatorial expertise spans a wide range of benthic invertebrate taxa of direct relevance to this contract, including annelids, crustaceans, mollusks, echinoderms, and cnidarians. The SIO-BIC team includes internationally recognized experts and research staff engaged in systematics, biodiversity surveys, deep-sea ecology, biogeography, and species-description research. Current and historical SIO faculty and curators have described numerous new species and families across these groups and maintain active research programs in global phylogenetics, invertebrate morphology, and marine biodiversity. Multiple trained assistants and collection specialists with broad marine invertebrate expertise are also available to process and curate specimens under rigorous museum standards. Furthermore, SIO's robust curation, digitization infrastructure, and global integration of specimen metadata ensure that NOAA's invertebrate holdings will be archived in a manner that maximizes accessibility, scientific value, and long-term preservation.

For these reasons, Scripps Institution of Oceanography's Benthic Invertebrate Collection represents a uniquely qualified and unmatched resource for the identification, verification, and curation of benthic invertebrates collected from NOAA's Alaska Fisheries Science Center bottom trawl surveys.

5. Market Research.

Market research indicates that the Scripps Institution of Oceanography Benthic Invertebrate Collection (SIO-BIC) is one of the largest and most comprehensive marine invertebrate research collections in the United States. SIO-BIC maintains more than 86,000 curated lots and over one million specimens. The institution also houses numerous type specimens and archival deep-sea collections that provide essential reference material for accurate identification of benthic invertebrates obtained during NOAA bottom trawl surveys. Scripps has internationally recognized taxonomic expertise on staff and extensive curatorial infrastructure capable of processing, identifying, and archiving marine invertebrates to modern museum standards.

During market research, no other institution was identified with the combined breadth of holdings, taxonomic specialization, reference material, and curatorial capacity necessary to support NOAA's requirements for Alaskan benthic invertebrate identification and long-term preservation. Cost estimates surveyed from other institutions indicate that SIO-BIC's projected costs are comparable to those of peer institutions with similar scientific capabilities. Based on available collections, expertise, and cost competitiveness, SIO-BIC represents the most suitable and capable source to meet NOAA's technical and scientific requirements.

6. Technical/Requirements Representative Certification

I certify that this requirement constitutes the Government's minimum needs and the supporting data provided herein is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

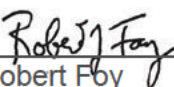
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1/28/2026

Christina Conrath
Research Fisheries Biologist, COR

Date



Robert Foy
Director, AFSC

2/26/2026

Date

7. Determination

I hereby determine that the circumstances of this action deem only one source is reasonably available. This determination is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

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Contracting Officer

Date